

LaNya Hood

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Dear Recruiter,

Hi! I'm LaNya Hood, a senior at the University of Michigan studying Human-Centered Data & AI, and I am genuinely excited about the opportunity to bring my AI/ML experience to a team that is doing meaningful work. I know recruiters review a lot of candidates, so let me make this easy: I am someone who has been building real AI systems since 2018, long before it was the thing to do, and I am just getting started.

Through my AI Systems coursework at Michigan, I shipped six projects including a four-agent LangGraph pipeline for automated fact-checking, a full RAG system combining BM25 retrieval with NLI-based verification, and an adaptive ReAct agent that dynamically adjusts its retrieval strategy based on confidence scoring. These were classroom projects, but I treated every one of them like production work, building with real datasets, evaluating on real metrics, and documenting everything thoroughly. I learn fast, I build things that work, and I always want to understand the why behind every system I touch.

On the industry side, I have had the chance to apply that knowledge in real roles. At Handshake AI, I work with multimodal data to improve LLM training accuracy. At Sandbox Services, I integrated AI forecasting tools into enterprise workflows, led research sessions with C-suite stakeholders, and built dashboards that actually moved the needle on decision-making. At the University of Michigan College of Engineering, I kept AWS cloud pipelines and centralized databases running cleanly and reliably. Each role taught me something new and made me a stronger engineer.

Outside of my technical work, I am a founder. I run Hood Photography, where I use OpenAI APIs and AI editing tools in my day-to-day business, and I co-founded BIPOC Builders, a platform dedicated to supporting underrepresented students. I am also building NeighborGrid, a data management platform for government and non-profits, and KNect, a resource platform for BIPOC college students. I care deeply about building AI that is equitable, responsible, and actually useful to people.

I bring experience in Python, R, SQL, and C++, hands-on experience with LangChain, LangGraph, OpenAI Codex, Google Gemini, Claude Code, AWS, and Microsoft Azure, and certifications in Google AI Essentials and Azure Essentials Professional, with the Google AI Professional Certificate currently in progress. Most importantly, I bring energy, adaptability, and a genuine love for this work.

I would love the chance to connect and share more about what I have been building. Thank you so much for taking the time to read this. It truly means a lot.

With excitement,

LaNya Hood